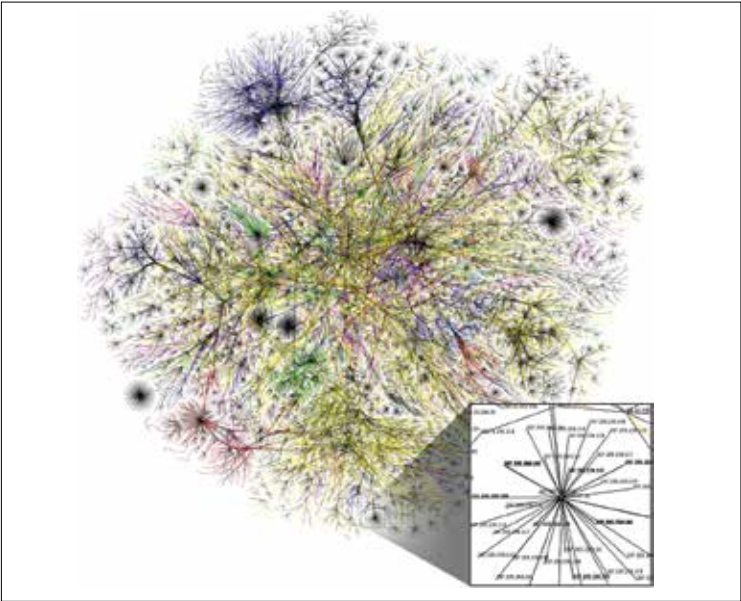




Network route structure of a small section of the internet

All the end points have an IP address, and even with IP addresses there can be many levels, corresponding to the levels of networks you just (hopefully) pictured in your head. Just as our communications have an underlying language to be meaningful, on the internet, there are protocols. Though as important as the internet, for this Fast Track, delving into protocols would be beyond the scope and beside the point.

Now, websites, web applications, or any entity that is accessible online (via the internet), are basically files sitting on a computer that has an address on the internet. To go to any website (without the help of search engines), you would need to know the address of the server where it is hosted. So you can also imagine the internet as a gigantic city with the same numbered signs outside every shop. You want the best chicken roast in town but you don't know what the shops contain, let alone which one is the best. All you can do is go visit them mechanically, one by one. Of course you could ask someone else too, but they would just be telling you what they knew, and even they couldn't know everything. What if you missed out on life because of the lack of information? The horror! Yellow pages to the rescue! Er, I mean, search engines.